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Inventor(s)

Elder, JR.; James Colston et al.

IMPROVED FOOD SERVICE BOX

Abstract

The present disclosure is drawn to improved food service boxes that in one embodiment is a beverage supported food box that enables a user to hold a beverage and food item with one hand. Alternately the beverage supported food box may be supported by the beverage that is placed in a beverage holder. Further, the food box may serve as a makeshift table when the beverage is placed in a cup holder. This device solves the problem of balancing multiple food and beverage items when no table is present. The food box may further comprise a condiment, or dipping sauce, holder, other food container, and/or utensil holder. The improved food service boxes can be made from a compostable material, shipped flat for reduced shipping costs, be compact for shipping and storing, have one-step food vendor assembly, and improved end-user experience.

Inventors: Elder, JR.; James Colston (Nashville, TN), Ciulis; Zachary Michael (Antioch, TN), Roth; Eric Dana (Old Hickory, TN)

Applicant: UPPERCUT BOX COMPANY (Nashville, TN)

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Background/Summary

[0001] A portion of the disclosure of this patent document contains material that is subject to copyright protection. The copyright owner has no objection to the reproduction of the patent document or the patent disclosure, as it appears in the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office patent file or records, but otherwise reserves all copyright rights whatsoever. CROSS-REFERENCES TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0002] This application is a non-provisional patent application claiming priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/557,899 filed Feb. 26, 2024, and the entirety of which is incorporated by reference.

FIELD

[0003] This disclosure relates to the field of food containment for take-out or to-go food, items wherein a person needs to carry a food item using the food container and/or eat a food item from the food container.

BACKGROUND

[0004] Often food served by vendors as take-out or to-go items from restaurants or at events, including concerts, sporting venues, festivals, parades, and other outdoor or indoor events, is supplied in cartons or boxes. These cartons or boxes can be cumbersome, hard to hold, and hard to carry especially if a beverage, more than one food item, and sauce or condiment items are also desired, and even further if a user is carrying orders for more than one person. A vendor is challenged with balancing price of these cartons, having storage space for cartons, time for assembling the cartons, and end user experience with the cartons where little to no table space is available. There is a need in the market to provide a price conscious, durable, compostable, compact, and convenient food carton that can be assembled quickly by a vendor, is easy to ship, and cost effective.

SUMMARY

[0005] The present disclosure is drawn to a food service box that in one embodiment is a beverage supported food box that enables a user to hold a beverage and food item with one hand. Alternately the beverage supported food box may be supported by the beverage that is placed in a beverage holder. This device solves the problem of balancing multiple food and beverage items when no table is present, making it easier to carry and consume food and beverages at events. Further, the beverage supported food box may serve as a makeshift table when the beverage is placed in a cup holder. The beverage food box may further comprise a condiment, dipping sauce, or additional food item storage portion, and/or utensil holder.

[0006] A food service box that can be assembled by the vendor in one step is disclosed. A food service box that is assembled from a single flat form piece is disclosed. A food service box that can be shipped flat to the vendor is disclosed. A food service box that is stackable is disclosed. A food service box that can reliably hold a condiment for use in dipping is disclosed. A food service box that is compostable is disclosed. A food service box that may be BPI certified is disclosed.

Embodiments of food service boxes disclosed herein are easy and inexpensive to manufacture, have a small shipping and storage footprint, are fast and easy to assemble by the vendor, and make carrying and eating a food item or items easier for an end user compared to prior art food cartons.

[0007] In a particular embodiment, an exemplary food box configured to engage a beverage container as disclosed herein may include one or more side walls, a beverage flap, and an aperture defined in the beverage flap. Each of the one or more side walls may include a top edge and a bottom edge. The beverage flap may have a top member and a bottom member. The top member may be connected to the top edge of a first side wall of the one or more side walls. At least a

portion of the bottom member may be attached to the first side wall. The aperture may be designed to engage the beverage container.

[0008] In an exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the one or more side walls may include four side walls configured to define an internal container space.

[0009] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the one or more side walls may define an internal container space.

[0010] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the internal container space may include a bottom formed by at least one bottom flap connected to at least one of the one or more side walls.

[0011] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, each of the one or more sides walls may include a bottom flap of the at least one bottom flap.

[0012] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the bottom of the internal container space may be formed by a single bottom flap.

[0013] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the top member and the bottom member of the beverage flap may be parallel.

[0014] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the top member of the beverage flap may contact the bottom member of the beverage flap.

[0015] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the beverage flap may further include a side wall portion defined between and configured to separate the top member and the bottom member.

[0016] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the side wall portion of the beverage flap may be positioned distal to the first side wall.

[0017] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the beverage flap may further include an end portion extending from the bottom member. The end portion may be configured to attach the bottom member to the first side wall.

[0018] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the end portion of the beverage flap may be connected to the first side wall via glue.

[0019] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the food box may include an additional flap connected to the top edge of a second side wall of the one or more side walls. The additional flap may have a cutout designed to receive a food container.

[0020] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the cutout may be defined in at least a top member of the additional flap. The top member may be connected to the top edge of the second side wall.

[0021] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the additional flap may further include a vertical member extending from the top member and a bottom member extending from the vertical member. The bottom member may be configured to attach to the second side wall.

[0022] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the top member and the bottom member of the additional flap may be parallel.

[0023] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the additional flap may further include an end portion extending from the bottom member. The end portion may be configured to attach the bottom member to the second side wall.

[0024] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the end portion of the additional flap may be connected to the second side wall via glue.

[0025] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the end portion of the additional flap may be connected to the second side wall via a friction lock when the end portion is received by a slot defined in the second side wall.

[0026] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the food box may be formed from a single flat piece of a material.

[0027] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the food box

may be formed from paper board.

[0028] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the food box may be formed of a compostable material.

[0029] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the food box may be made from at least one of a group of a compostable paper, a compostable wood product, a compostable plastic, a compostable bamboo, a compostable paper board, and a compostable hemp.

[0030] In another embodiment, a food box as disclosed herein may include one or more side walls, a condiment flap, and at least one cutout. Each of the one or more side walls may have a top edge and a bottom edge. The condiment flap may have a top member and a bottom member. The top member may be connected to the top edge of a first side wall of the one or more side walls. The bottom member may be couplable to the first side wall between the top edge and the bottom edge. The at least one cutout may be defined in the condiment flap and may be designed to receive a food container.

[0031] In another embodiment, a method of forming a food box as disclosed herein may comprise: (a) cutting a flat shape including (i) four side walls, wherein the side walls comprise a flap with square corners; (ii) a beverage flap extending from a top edge of the first or second side walls, the beverage flap comprising at least two apertures and a beverage flap notched end, wherein the at least two apertures are configured to fit around a beverage container; and (iii) a beverage flap slit, configured to receive the beverage flap notched end, in either the first or second side walls where the beverage flap extends from; (b) folding the flat shape into a configured food box; and (c) fitting the beverage flap notched end into the beverage flap slit of either the first or second side walls.

[0032] In an exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the method may further comprise: including at least one side flap having a cutout configured to receive a condiment container extending from at least one of the third or fourth side walls in the flat shape, wherein the at least one side flap comprises a side flap notched end and the at least one of the third or fourth side walls comprises a slit to receive the side flap notched end; and fitting the side flap notched end into the slit of either of the at least one of the third or fourth side walls.

[0033] In a further embodiment, a food box when configured for use, as disclosed herein, may comprise: (a) at least one side wall forming an open space with an upper aperture, wherein a top edge of the at least one side wall is connected to a cover flap; (b) wherein the cover flap comprises a bottom edge and an outer edge, and the bottom edge is connected to the top edge of the at least one side wall; (c) wherein the cover flap comprises a top side connected to the top edge of the at least one side wall; (d) wherein when the cover flap comprises an end connected to the at least one side wall; (e) wherein the cover flap comprises at least one cutout to receive a condiment flap; and (f) wherein the cover flap fits over the open space in a closed position to form a flat cover for the food box.

[0034] In an exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the cutout of the cover flap may be adhered to the at least one side wall when configured for use.

[0035] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the cutout may be adhered using a glue.

[0036] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the glue may be a compostable glue.

[0037] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the outer edge of the cover flap may be adhered to the at least one side wall when configured for use.

[0038] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the outer edge of the cover flap may be connected via a friction lock to the at least one side wall when configured for use.

[0039] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the food box may be configured for use from a planar material.

[0040] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the planar

material may be a compostable material.

[0041] In another exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, the planar material may be a paperboard.

[0042] In another embodiment, a method of forming a food box as disclosed herein may comprise: (a) cutting a flat shape comprising: (i) four side walls, wherein the side walls comprise a flap with square corners; (ii) a condiment flap extending from a top edge of the first or second side walls, the beverage flap comprising at least two apertures and a condiment flap notched end, wherein the at least two apertures are configured to fit around a condiment container; and (iii) a condiment flap slit, configured to receive the condiment flap notched end, in either the first or second side walls where the condiment flap extends from; (b) folding the flat shape into a configured food box; and (c) fitting the condiment flap notched end into the condiment flap slit of either the first or second side walls.

[0043] In an exemplary aspect according to the above-referenced embodiment, step (c) of the method may further comprise forming a flat top from an upper portion of the condiment flap.

Description

DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0044] FIG. 1 is a top-perspective view of a first embodiment of a beverage supported food box configured for end consumer use.

[0045] FIG. 2 is a front-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box, wherein the LOGO is positioned on the front of the beverage supported food box.

[0046] FIG. 3 is back-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0047] FIG. 4 is a left-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0048] FIG. 5 is a right-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box, wherein the LOGO is positioned on the right side of the beverage supported food box.

[0049] FIG. 6 is a top-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0050] FIG. 7 is a bottom-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0051] FIG. 8 is a perspective view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box in use by the end consumer.

[0052] FIG. 9 is a perspective view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box before manufacturer assembly.

[0053] FIG. 10 is a left-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box flat-folded ready-to-ship following manufacturer assembly.

[0054] FIG. 11 is a right-side view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box flat-folded ready-to-ship following manufacturer assembly.

[0055] FIG. 12 is a perspective view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box, partially unfolded prior to vendor use.

[0056] FIG. 13 is a perspective view of the first embodiment of a beverage supported food box, partially unfolded prior to vendor use.

[0057] FIG. 14 is a front-perspective view of a second embodiment of a beverage supported food box with a utensil holder cutout configured for end consumer use.

[0058] FIG. 15 is a right-side view of the second embodiment of a beverage supported food box with a utensil holder cutout.

[0059] FIG. 16 is a top-perspective view of the second embodiment of a beverage supported food box with a utensil holder cutout configured for end consumer use.

[0060] FIG. 17 is a left-side view of the second embodiment of a beverage supported food box with a utensil holder cutout.

[0061] FIG. 18 is a top perspective view of a third embodiment of a beverage supported food box

configured for end consumer use.

[0062] FIG. **19** is a front-side view of the third embodiment of a beverage supported food box, wherein the LOGO is positioned on the front of the beverage supported food box.

[0063] FIG. **20** is back-side view of the third embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0064] FIG. **21** is a left-side view of the third embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0065] FIG. **22** is a right-side view of the third embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0066] FIG. **23** is a top-side view of the third embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0067] FIG. **24** is a bottom-side view of the third embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0068] FIG. **25** is a perspective view of the third embodiment of a beverage supported food box before manufacturer assembly.

[0069] FIG. **26** is a top-perspective view of a fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box configured for end consumer use.

[0070] FIG. **27** is a front-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0071] FIG. **28** is back-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0072] FIG. **29** is a left-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0073] FIG. **30** is a right-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0074] FIG. **31** is a top-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0075] FIG. **32** is a bottom-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0076] FIG. **33** is a perspective view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box before manufacturer assembly.

[0077] FIG. **34** is a front-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box in a manufacturer assembled ready-to-ship configuration.

[0078] FIG. **35** is a back-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box in a manufacturer assembled ready-to-ship configuration.

[0079] FIG. **36** is a front-side view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box partially unfolded prior to vendor use.

[0080] FIG. **37** front-side perspective view of the fourth embodiment of a beverage supported food box partially unfolded prior to vendor use.

[0081] FIG. **38** is a front-side view of a fifth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0082] FIG. **39** is a front-side view of a fifth embodiment of a beverage supported food box.

[0083] FIG. **40** is a perspective view of a sixth embodiment of a beverage supported food box configured for end consumer use.

[0084] FIG. **41** is a perspective view of a first embodiment of an improved food service box configured for end consumer use.

[0085] FIG. **42** is a front-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0086] FIG. **43** is a back-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0087] FIG. **44** is a left-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0088] FIG. **45** is a right-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0089] FIG. **46** is a top-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0090] FIG. **47** is a bottom-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0091] FIG. **48** is the first embodiment of an improved food service box in a pre-manufacturer assembly configuration.

[0092] FIG. **49** is a right-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box in a post-manufacturer assembly, ready-to-ship configuration.

[0093] FIG. **50** is a left-side view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box in a post-manufacturer assembly, ready-to-ship configuration.

[0094] FIG. **51** is a perspective view of the first embodiment of an improved food service box shown in an assembled, stackable, vendor use configuration.

[0095] FIG. **52** is a top-perspective view of a second embodiment of an improved food service box configured for end consumer use.

[0096] FIG. **53** is another top-perspective view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box configured for end consumer use.

[0097] FIG. **54** is a bottom-perspective view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box configured for end consumer use.

[0098] FIG. **55** is a front-side view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0099] FIG. **56** is a back-side view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0100] FIG. **57** is a left-side view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0101] FIG. **58** is a right-side view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0102] FIG. **59** is a top-side view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0103] FIG. **60** is a bottom-side view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box.

[0104] FIG. **61** is a perspective view of the second embodiment of an improved food service box in a pre-manufacturer assembly configuration.

[0105] Before explaining the disclosed embodiments of the present invention in detail, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited in its application to the details of the particular arrangement shown, since the invention is capable of other embodiments. Also, the terminology used herein is for the purpose of description and not of limitation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

Summary

[0106] Embodiments of the present disclosure including beverage supported food boxes, and methods of providing a beverage-supported food box, as described herein, are shown in FIGS. **1-40**. The beverage supported food boxes enable a user to hold a beverage and food item with one hand. Alternately the beverage supported food box may be supported by the beverage that is placed in a beverage holder. This device solves the problem of holding multiple food and beverage items when no table is present. Further, the beverage supported food box may serve as a makeshift table when the beverage is placed in a cup holder. The beverage supported food box may further comprise a condiment or dipping sauce holder, a side item or additional food container holder, and/or utensil holder. Further, the beverage supported food boxes provide low cost, easy to ship, small footprint, space saving, easy to assemble, in some cases compostable, and in some cases BPI certified food boxes for vendors to provide to end consumers.

[0107] Embodiments of improved food service boxes as described herein are shown in FIGS. **41-61**. The improved food service boxes disclosed herein provide a device and method for providing a low cost, easy to ship, small footprint, space saving, easy to assemble, compostable, and BPI certified food box to provide to end users that improves ease of use over prior art food service boxes.

Terms

[0108] As used herein, conditional terms including but not limited to “can”, “could”, “might”, or “may”, unless expressly stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context of use, are generally meant to mean that certain examples include, while other examples do not include, particular features, steps, and/or elements. These terms are not generally meant to imply that features, steps, and/or elements are required for one or more examples or that one or more examples necessarily includes logic for deciding, with or without user input or prompting, whether these features, steps, and/or elements are included or performed in any particular examples.

[0109] As used herein, conjunction language such as the phrase “at least one of X, Y, and Z”, unless otherwise stated, is understood to mean that an item, term, or element, etc., may be either X, Y, or Z, or any combination thereof. It is not generally intended to imply that certain examples require at least one of X, at least one of Y, and at least one of Z to be present. Use of the phrase, “at least one of X, Y, or Z, as used in general to mean that an item, term, or element, etc., may be either X, Y, or Z, or any combination thereof.

[0110] As used herein, the word “or” in reference to a list of two or more items includes all the following interpretations: any one of the items in the list, all the items in the list, and any

combination of items in the list. Likewise, the term “and/or” in reference to a list of two or more items, includes all the following interpretations: any one of the items in the list, all the items in the list, and any combinations of items in the list.

[0111] As used herein, the terms “comprise”, “comprises”, and “comprising” are to be construed as inclusive terms, as opposed to exclusive or exhaustive, meaning “including, but not limited to.”

[0112] As used herein, “adhered”, “connected”, “attached”, “joined”, “mounted”, “fastened” or “coupled”, or any variant thereof, means any connection or coupling, either direct or indirect between two elements which may be physical, logical, or a combination thereof. These words should be interpreted to mean any manner of joining two objects including, but not limited to, the use of any fasteners such as screws, nuts and bolts, bolts, pin and clevis, and the like allowing for a stationary, translatable, or pivotable relationship; welding of any kind such as traditional MIG welding, TIG welding, friction welding, brazing, soldering, ultrasonic welding, torch welding, inductive welding, and the like; using any resin, glue, epoxy, and the like; being integrally formed as a single part together; any mechanical fit such as a friction fit, interference fit, slidable fit, rotatable fit, pivotable fit, and the like; any combination thereof; and the like.

[0113] As used herein, the words “herein”, “above”, or “below”, and similar words, when used in the application, refer to the application as a whole and not to a single section of the application.

[0114] As used herein, “substantially” is defined as to a great or significant extent, for the most part, or essentially. For example, a substantially horizontal member, plane, or surface may be within one degree or two degrees from horizontal.

[0115] As used herein, “semi-rigid” or “semi-rigid material” means a material which is stiff and moderately rigid and flexible in nature in terms of its hardness property of the materials. These materials have adequate mechanical strength and other functional properties. These materials can be made, in non-limiting examples, others of which are presented elsewhere in this disclosure, either from cellulosic materials like paperboard or the different packaging formats made from paperboard like folding cartons, lined cartons, paper-based laminated composite carton.

[0116] As used herein, the term “about” is defined as almost, for example when describing an angle as about 90 degrees, the angle may fall within one to five degrees of 90 degrees. In another example, a percentage that is described as about fifty percent may be forty-five degrees or between forty-five degrees and fifty-five degrees.

[0117] The term “manufacturer” refers to an agent or agents, being a business or company comprising person(s) that create, cut, fold, glue, and/or assemble a product to provide, or ship, to a vendor.

[0118] The term “vendor” refers to an agent or agents, being a business or company comprising person(s) that further assemble, unfold, fold, or otherwise produce an end-user product for a consumer.

[0119] The term “end user” or “consumer” refers to an agent or agents, being person(s), who use the beverage supported food box or improved food service box of the current disclosure.

Description

[0120] With reference to FIGS. 1-13, a beverage supported food box **100**, FIG. 1 comprising at least one side wall **101** connected to a beverage flap **107** is disclosed. The beverage flap top edge **113** is connected to at least one side wall **101** of a food box **100** at a top edge of the side wall **213**. The shape of the side wall **101** may vary and take the shape of, in non-limiting examples, a square, rectangle, triangle, circle, or oval, making the food box which encloses a space **114** a three-dimensional shape comprising in non-limiting examples a rectangle, square, triangular prism, cone, or cylinder comprising one non-enclosed or open side to receive a food item. In other terms, although the example beverage supported food box **100** disclosed is shown with four side walls **101**, **102**, **103**, **104**, a food box of the present disclosure may comprise at least one side wall, at least two side walls, at least three side walls, at least four side walls, or at least five side walls, or at least six side walls, or more. For example, the beverage supported food box **100**, **200**, **300**, **400**,

500, 600, 700 and/or food service boxes **800, 900** described herein in the three-dimensional in-use configuration shown herein may take the shape, in non-limiting examples, of a rectangle, square, cube, triangular prism, cylinder, cone, half or partial sphere, cylinder, pyramid, tetrahedron, or octahedron, some of which non-limiting examples are illustrated in FIGS. **38-40**. The beverage supported food box **100, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700** and/or food service boxes **800, 900** described herein may comprise an open top, as shown, lacking a physical top to cover the interior space **114**. [0121] As shown in FIG. **1**, a top edge of a side wall **213** connects to a beverage flap **107** which may comprise at least two beverage apertures **112**, that, when configured for use by an end user, align to receive a beverage container **130**, FIG. **8**. As shown in FIG. **1** an outer edge or end **111** of the beverage flap **107** is attached to the side wall **101** to form the configured for-use box **100**, FIG. **1**. The outer edge or end **111** of the beverage flap **107** may also be referred to as an end portion **111**. This beverage flap end **111** may be glued, as shown in FIG. **1**, or otherwise attached to the side wall **101**, such as with a friction lock. A friction lock comprises a notched tab that slides into a slit in, for example, in a side wall **101, 104**. The disclosed food box with at least one side wall **101** comprising a beverage flap **107** may further comprise a condiment flap **115**, and/or a utensil cutout holder **125**, FIG. **14**, and other features. Other features, embodiments, methods of assembly and use, as described herein, apply to each embodiment disclosed.

[0122] In an example, with reference to FIGS. **1-13**, the disclosed beverage supported food box **100** comprises a first side wall **101**, and second side wall **102**, opposing the first side wall **101**. The beverage supported food box **100** further comprises a third side wall **103**, and fourth side wall **104**, wherein the third side wall **103** opposes the fourth side wall **104**. The side walls **101, 102, 103, 104** may join at least one other side wall **101, 102, 103, 104**, or two other side walls depending on the state of configuration of the beverage supported food box **100, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700** and/or food service boxes **800, 900** described herein at side wall side edges **120**. The beverage supported food box **100** further comprises a bottom portion **105**, FIG. **6** wherein the bottom **105** connects to at least one side walls **102** at a bottom edge **106** as shown in FIG. **1**. As shown in FIG. **7**, the bottom **105** is supported or partially supported by one or more, at least two, or at least three or more different bottom flaps **121** that may be glued or friction locked together before shipping to the vendor. Bottom flaps **121** may be square, triangular, or of irregular shapes having at least two open edges, or at least three open edges, wherein the open edges are edges not attached to other pieces of the good box upon initial stamping or cutout of the flat form of the beverage supported food box from material of composition as shown in FIG. **9** and other flat form embodiments. The bottom flaps **121** may comprise at least three sides, or at least four sides, or at least five sides, one of which is adhered, attached, or otherwise shared with a side wall bottom edge **106** as shown in FIG. **9**. When configured for use, the side walls **101, 102, 103, 104**, bottom **105** and/or bottom flaps **121** form an interior space **114**.

[0123] As shown in FIGS. **1-13**, the beverage supported food box **100** comprises at least one beverage flap **107**. The beverage flap **107** comprises a top member **108**, vertical member **110**, and a bottom member **109**. In certain optional embodiments, the top member **108** and the bottom member **109** may be parallel. The beverage flap end **111** connects to a side wall **101, 102, 103, 104**. As shown, the beverage flap **107** connects to the first side wall **101** at the beverage flap end **111**. The beverage flap **107** may be attached at the end **111** to the same side wall **101** it is connected to. The beverage flap **107** may comprise at least one or two, or more beverage apertures **112**, or openings to receive a beverage container **130**, FIG. **8**. FIG. **8** illustrates how a beverage container **130** may be fitted through the beverage aperture(s) **112** formed when the beverage flap **107** is folded for use. Although the beverage flap **107** is shown attached to the exterior of the side wall **101**, it can be envisioned that the beverage flap may be attached to the interior of a side wall **101**. A customer's hand could hold the beverage container **130** and support the beverage flap **107** thereby supporting the beverage supported food box **100** in use.

[0124] With reference to FIG. **1**, the beverage flap **107** may be connected, via an end **111** to the

same side wall **101**, **102**, **103**, **104** in several ways. For instance, a friction lock may be used. In a friction lock, the end of the beverage flap **111** may be notched to form a tab that may be inserted into a slit in a side wall **101**. In another embodiment, as shown in FIGS. **1** and **3**, as well as in other figures, a beverage flap end **111** or portion of the beverage flap **107** may be connected, adhered to, or glued a side wall **101**, **102**, **103**, **104** via adhesive material such that a portion of the beverage flap **107** lays flat against a portion of the side wall **101** and adhesive material is used to permanently or semi-permanently adhere the beverage flap **107** to the side wall **101**. Adhesive material used may include but not be limited to a cold glue, hot melt glue, or other adhesive such as epoxy, polyurethane, or polyimide adhesives. The adhesive, in an embodiment, is compostable, in another embodiment, the adhesive may also be a BPI (Biodegradable Products Institute, New York, USA) certified compostable adhesive.

[0125] A cold glue is a type of glue, or adhesive, that comes in a thick liquid, or liquid, form and sets to a flexible bond when it's applied to porous materials. It forms a long-lasting bond that won't break down over time. Cold glue can be used to adhere a variety of materials together, including wood, fabric, paper, paper board, and more. A cold glue may also be ecologically friendly being water based and water soluble.

[0126] A hot melt glue, or hot-melt adhesive (HMA), is a form of thermoplastic adhesive that starts out as a solid and transforms into a liquid when heated. Once applied, the glue solidifies upon cooling, creating a strong bond between surfaces. Hot melt glue is made up of three main components: a polymer base, a tackifier, and various additives. The polymer base, which can be ethylene-vinyl acetate (EVA), polyurethane (PUR), or polyamide (PA), determines the overall characteristics of the glue.

[0127] With reference to FIGS. **1** and **8**, the two beverage apertures **112** of the beverage flap **107** are designed to fit around a beverage container FIG. **8**, **130** in the in-use beverage supported food box **100**. This beverage container **130** may be a disposable, or recyclable beverage container made from metal, as an example aluminum, plastic, or paper products, or other beverage container such as a reusable beverage container **130** with varying dimensions, being a bottle, can, or cup. The at least one or two beverage apertures FIG. **1**, **112** may be different sizes, one being smaller or larger than the other, or they may be the same size. As shown in FIGS. **1**, **6**, **7**, and **8**, the two beverage apertures **112** may be round or substantially round. Beverage apertures **112** may be oval, square, or rectangular, or any shape designed to receive a specific beverage container **130**. In an example each of the beverage apertures **112** may have a width of at least one inch, or at least 1.1 inches, or at least 1.2 inches, or at least 1.3 inches, or at least 1.4 inches, or at least 1.5 inches, or at least 1.6 inches, or at least 1.7 inches, or at least 1.8 inches, or at least 1.9 inches, or at least 2 inches, or at least 2.1 inches, or at least 2.2 inches, or at least 2.3 inches, or at least 2.4 inches, or at least 2.5 inches, or at least 2.6 inches, or at least 2.7 inches, or at least 2.8 inches, or at least 2.9 inches, or at least 3.1 inches, or at least 3.2 inches, or at least 3.3 inches, or at least 3.4 inches, or at least 3.5 inches, or at least 3.6 inches, or at least 3.7 inches, or at least 3.8 inches, or at least 3.9 inches, or at least 4 inches, or at least 4.1 inches, or at least 4.2 inches, or at least 4.3 inches, or at least 4.4 inches, or at least 4.5 inches or at least 4.6 inches or at least 4.7 inches, or at least 4.8 inches, or at least 4.9 inches, or at least 5 inches or more.

[0128] The beverage flap **107** may span the entire length of the side wall **101**, **102**, **103**, **104** it is connected to. In another embodiment the beverage flap **107** may span less than the entire length of the side wall **101** it is connected to. In another embodiment, the beverage flap **107** may span longer than the side wall it is connected to, having a trapezoidal shape for instance. The beverage flap **107**, when folded and connected to its side wall **101**, comprises a top horizontal member **108**, vertical member **110**, and bottom horizontal member **109** formed by folding the beverage flap **107**. The top span **108** and bottom span **109** may be connected to the side wall at an angle, wherein the angle may be from 0-180 degrees, or 0 degrees, or 1 degree, or 5 degrees, or 10 degrees, or 15 degrees, or 20 degrees, or 25 degrees, or 30 degrees, or 45 degrees, or 50 degrees, or 55 degrees, or 60 degrees,

or 65 degrees, or 70 degrees, or 75 degrees, or 80 degrees, or 90 degrees, or 95 degrees, or 100 degrees, or 115 degrees, or 120 degrees, or 125 degrees, or 130 degrees, or 135 degrees, or 140 degrees, or 145 degrees, or 150 degrees, or 155 degrees, or 160 degrees, or 165 degrees, or 170 degrees, or 175 degrees, or 179 degrees, or 180 degrees.

[0129] With reference to FIGS. **1-13**, the beverage supported food box **100** is formed from a semi-rigid material which can be folded. A material that is re-usable or recyclable is preferred. A material that is compostable is preferred. A material that is a BPI certified compostable material is preferred. These materials may be but are not limited to metals, metal alloys, plastics, wood products, paper products, paper board, bamboo, and hemp. A compostable material for example may be a compostable paper, a compostable wood product, a compostable plastic, a compostable bamboo, a compostable paper board, and a compostable hemp.

[0130] The beverage supported food box **100** may be formed from a material that may be coated, the coating may include coatings designed to prevent grease or other food products from seeping into or through the material, and/or coatings designed to protect the integrity of the box material and/or any printing or ink on the box. These coatings may be compostable in nature. In other examples, material of the food boxes disclosed herein may intrinsically contain or be manufactured with a coating such as a grease barrier, preventing grease or other food product from seeping into or through the box material. A grease barrier coating may be applied to the interior **114** surfaces of the example food boxes described herein. The grease barrier coating may also be applied to an exterior surface. In another example, a heat-resistant coating may be applied to the outside surfaces of the example boxes. The heat resistance coating may help maintain the integrity of the box material and prevent ink or printings from melting or otherwise deforming, especially if the boxes are placed under heat lamps or warming ovens to keep the food inside warm. Examples of coatings may include waxes, plastics, compostable plastics, heat resistant aqueous and nonaqueous coatings, acrylic, and waterborne acrylic coatings.

[0131] When folded as illustrated in FIGS. **1-8**, the four side walls **101**, **102**, **103**, and **104** form a five-sided three-dimensional shape with an interior space **114** designed to receive and hold a food item **150**, or multiple food items **150**. The three-dimensional shape of the beverage supported food box **100** may include a square or rectangle. It can be envisioned that a folded beverage supported food box **500**, **600**, **700** as illustrated in FIGS. **38-40** may have one side wall **601**, **701** or two side walls, or three side walls, or four side walls, or five side walls, or six side walls, or seven side walls, or eight side walls, or more.

[0132] The overall dimensions of the beverage supported food box **100**, **200**, **300**, **400**, **500**, **600**, **700** or other food boxes described herein, include a length, along an x axis, a depth, along a y axis, and a width, along a z axis. The x axis, or x-coordinate axis, y axis, or y-coordinate axis, and z axis, or x-coordinate axis follow the Cartesian coordinate system. Thus the beverage supported food box **100**, **200**, **300**, **400**, **500**, **600**, **700** may have a length, not including an example beverage flap or condiment flap, at a top edge of a side wall, of at least one inch, or at least 1.1 inches, or 1.2 inches, or 1.3 inches, or 1.4 inches, or 1.5 inches, or 1.6 inches, or 1.7 inches, or 1.8 inches, or 1.9 inches, or 2 inches, or 2.1 inches, or 2.2 inches, or 2.3 inches, or 2.4 inches, or 2.5 inches, or 2.6 inches, or 2.7 inches, or 2.8 inches, or 2.9 inches, or 3 inches, or 3.1 inches, or at least 3.2 inches, or at least 3.3 inches, or at least 3.4 inches, or at least 3.5 inches, or at least 3.6 inches, or at least 3.7 inches, or at least 3.8 inches, or at least 3.9 inches, or at least 4 inches, or at least 4.1 inches, or at least 4.2 inches, or at least 4.3 inches, or at least 4.4 inches, or at least 4.5 inches or at least 4.6 inches or at least 4.7 inches, or at least 4.8 inches, or at least 4.9 inches, or at least 5 inches, or at least 5.1 inches, or at least 5.2 inches, or at least 5.3 inches, or at least 5.4 inches, or at least 5.5 inches, or at least 5.6 inches, or at least 5.7 inches, or at least 5.8 inches, or at least 5.9 inches, or at least 6 inches, or at least 6.1 inches, or at least 6.2 inches, or at least 6.3 inches, or at least 6.4 inches, or at least 6.5 inches or at least 6.6 inches or at least 6.7 inches, or at least 6.8 inches, or at least 6.9 inches, or at least 7 inches, or at least 7.1 inches, or at least 7.2 inches, or at least 7.3 inches, or at

least 7.4 inches, or at least 7.5 inches, or at least 7.6 inches, or at least 7.7 inches, or at least 7.8 inches, or at least 7.9 inches, or at least 8 inches, or at least 8.1 inches, or at least 8.2 inches, or at least 8.3 inches, or at least 8.4 inches, or at least 8.5 inches or at least 8.6 inches or at least 8.7 inches, or at least 8.8 inches, or at least 8.9 inches, or at least 9 inches, or 10 inches, or more, in length.

[0133] The beverage supported food box **100, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700**, or other food boxes described herein, may be, not including an example beverage flap or condiment flap, at least one inch in depth, or at least 1.1 inches, or 1.2 inches, or 1.3 inches, or 1.4 inches, or 1.5 inches, or 1.6 inches, or 1.7 inches, or 1.8 inches, or 1.9 inches, or 2 inches, or 2.1 inches, or 2.2 inches, or 2.3 inches, or 2.4 inches, or 2.5 inches, or 2.6 inches, or 2.7 inches, or 2.8 inches, or 2.9 inches, or 3 inches, or 3.1 inches, or at least 3.2 inches, or at least 3.3 inches, or at least 3.4 inches, or at least 3.5 inches, or at least 3.6 inches, or at least 3.7 inches, or at least 3.8 inches, or at least 3.9 inches, or at least 4 inches, or at least 4.1 inches, or at least 4.2 inches, or at least 4.3 inches, or at least 4.4 inches, or at least 4.5 inches or at least 4.6 inches or at least 4.7 inches, or at least 4.8 inches, or at least 4.9 inches, or at least 5 inches, or at least 5.1 inches, or at least 5.2 inches, or at least 5.3 inches, or at least 5.4 inches, or at least 5.5 inches, or at least 5.6 inches, or at least 5.7 inches, or at least 5.8 inches, or at least 5.9 inches, or at least 6 inches, or at least 6.1 inches, or at least 6.2 inches, or at least 6.3 inches, or at least 6.4 inches, or at least 6.5 inches or at least 6.6 inches or at least 6.7 inches, or at least 6.8 inches, or at least 6.9 inches, or at least 7 inches, or at least 7.1 inches, or at least 7.2 inches, or at least 7.3 inches, or at least 7.4 inches, or at least 7.5 inches, or at least 7.6 inches, or at least 7.7 inches, or at least 7.8 inches, or at least 7.9 inches, or at least 8 inches, or at least 8.1 inches, or at least 8.2 inches, or at least 8.3 inches, or at least 8.4 inches, or at least 8.5 inches or at least 8.6 inches or at least 8.7 inches, or at least 8.8 inches, or at least 8.9 inches, or at least 9 inches, or 10 inches, or more, in depth.

[0134] The beverage supported food box **100, 200, 300, 400, 500, 600, 700**, or other food service boxes disclosed herein may be, not including an example beverage flap or condiment flap, at least one inch in width, or at least one inch in depth, or at least 1.1 inches, or 1.2 inches, or 1.3 inches, or 1.4 inches, or 1.5 inches, or 1.6 inches, or 1.7 inches, or 1.8 inches, or 1.9 inches, or 2 inches, or 2.1 inches, or 2.2 inches, or 2.3 inches, or 2.4 inches, or 2.5 inches, or 2.6 inches, or 2.7 inches, or 2.8 inches, or 2.9 inches, or 3 inches, or 3.1 inches, or at least 3.2 inches, or at least 3.3 inches, or at least 3.4 inches, or at least 3.5 inches, or at least 3.6 inches, or at least 3.7 inches, or at least 3.8 inches, or at least 3.9 inches, or at least 4 inches, or at least 4.1 inches, or at least 4.2 inches, or at least 4.3 inches, or at least 4.4 inches, or at least 4.5 inches or at least 4.6 inches or at least 4.7 inches, or at least 4.8 inches, or at least 4.9 inches, or at least 5 inches, or at least 5.1 inches, or at least 5.2 inches, or at least 5.3 inches, or at least 5.4 inches, or at least 5.5 inches, or at least 5.6 inches, or at least 5.7 inches, or at least 5.8 inches, or at least 5.9 inches, or at least 6 inches, or at least 6.1 inches, or at least 6.2 inches, or at least 6.3 inches, or at least 6.4 inches, or at least 6.5 inches or at least 6.6 inches or at least 6.7 inches, or at least 6.8 inches, or at least 6.9 inches, or at least 7 inches, or at least 7.1 inches, or at least 7.2 inches, or at least 7.3 inches, or at least 7.4 inches, or at least 7.5 inches, or at least 7.6 inches, or at least 7.7 inches, or at least 7.8 inches, or at least 7.9 inches, or at least 8 inches, or at least 8.1 inches, or at least 8.2 inches, or at least 8.3 inches, or at least 8.4 inches, or at least 8.5 inches or at least 8.6 inches or at least 8.7 inches, or at least 8.8 inches, or at least 8.9 inches, or at least 9 inches, or 10 inches, or more, in width.

[0135] As shown in FIGS. **1-13**, the beverage supported food box **100** may additionally comprise at least one condiment holder being a condiment flap **115** comprising a top member **116**, a bottom member **117**, and a vertical member **118**. In certain optional embodiments, the bottom member **117** may be angled relative to the top member **116**. Although this condiment flap **115** is described in the present as receiving a condiment, being food items like ketchup, mustard, mayonnaise, pickles, onions, or the like, the condiment flap(s) described herein **115** may also be designed to receive a dipping sauce such as a cheese, barbecue or other sauce. In other examples the condiment flap **115**

may be designed to receive any additional food item, non-limiting examples being a salad, pasta, French fries, or vegetable item. The condiment flap **115** may be connected to a side wall **104** at the top of the side wall **213** at a first end of the condiment flap **313**. The beverage supported food box may comprise multiple condiment flaps **115**, being at least two, or at least three, or at least four. A second end **126** of the condiment flap attaches to a side wall **104**. The condiment flap **115** comprises at least one condiment cutout **119** to receive a condiment cup **140**, FIG. **8**. This condiment cutout **119** is generally round to conform to the shape of a condiment cup **140**, also known as a ramekin, or sauce cup, but may take other shapes or receive alternate forms of condiment or accessory food item containers. As shown in FIGS. **1** and **9**, the condiment cutout **119** may comprise a cutout folded or depressed during use to meet a portion of the side wall **104** and in some cases a portion of the bottom horizontal member **117** of the condiment flap **115**. In alternate versions of the beverage supported food box **400**, FIG. **26**, the condiment cutout **119** may be adhered to the bottom horizontal member **117** during the manufacturer's assembly process. The condiment cutout **119** may be designed to fold in a portion of the vertical member **118** of the condiment flap as shown in FIG. **1**. Alternately the condiment cutout **119** may be designed to fold in a portion of the side wall **104** as shown for beverage supported food box **400**, FIG. **26**. The dimensions and shape of the condiment cutout **119** allows a lip of a condiment cup **140** to set atop the condiment horizontal member **116** and sit in the condiment cutout **119** securely. This ensures that the condiment cup **140** will not fall out or be pushed through the condiment flap **115** or bottom horizontal member of the flap **117** opening during use. The bottom of a condiment cup may for instance rest on the condiment cutout **119** and/or bottom horizontal member **117**.

[0136] In folded, in-use configuration, the condiment flap **115** is folded to the exterior of the food box **100** to comprise a top horizontal member **116** that may substantially form a **90** degree angle with the side wall **104** it is attached to. In other words, the top horizontal member **116** may lay substantially horizontally. The condiment flap **115** further comprises a vertical member **118** that may form an angle of about, or substantially 90 degrees to the top horizontal member **116**. The condiment flap **115** further comprises a bottom member **117** that may be angled to meet the side wall **104** at an angle of about 90 to about 175 degrees from the vertical member **118** and attached to the side wall **104** via a friction lock system as shown in FIGS. **1** and **4** or attached to the side wall **104** via adhesion or gluing as shown in FIG. **26**. In certain optional embodiments, the top horizontal member **116** may be parallel to the bottom member **117**.

[0137] In a second embodiment, the beverage supported food box **200** may further comprise a utensil holder cutout **125** as illustrated in FIGS. **14-17**. This utensil holder cutout may be used in any of the embodied food boxes described herein. The utensil holder cutout **125** may be designed as a utensil cutout **125** in one of the corners of the food box as shown, at the top edge **213** of two side walls **101**, **102**, **103**, **104**. Alternately, the utensil holder **125** may be designed into one of the side walls **101**, **102**, **103**, **104**. The utensil holder is shown as formed from a cutout in the material of the food box **100**, but also may be formed using an additional piece of box material attached to or adhered to a food box.

[0138] The beverage supported food box **100**, **200**, **300**, **400**, **500**, **600**, **700** and food service boxes **800**, **900** described herein are designed with cost of materials, cost of manufacture, cost of assembly during manufacturing, time of assembly during manufacturing and especially time for vendor assembly, cost of shipping, and ease of user use of a vendor food service agent and end user in mind. To this end, as shown in FIGS. **9**, **25**, **33**, **48**, and **61** the food boxes may be cut or stamped from a semi-rigid material as a single flat sheet. Methods for cutting or stamping, for example a semi-rigid compostable paper product, are known in the industry and may include but are not limited to forming a cut mould, a cutting die, an example being a steel rule cutting die, that is pressed to the paper product that creates the single flat sheet with beverage apertures **112**, condiment cutout **119**, and slit **122** to receive ends **111**, **126** of beverage flap **107** and/or condiment flap **115**, and utensil cutout, if any. Before or after cutting, the beverage supported food box **100**, or

other food boxes disclosed herein, may be printed to make the configured food box a particular color and/or print an image or word, or words, that may be a logo, printed or otherwise marked, stamped, cut, etched, or laser printed onto the single flat food box **100**. The design of the food box **100** enables the device to be a low cost, easy to assemble, easy to manufacture, and easy to use device with a one-step assembly by a food vendor.

[0139] Before shipping to a vendor, the single flat sheet, FIG. **9** may be folded by the manufacturer as shown in FIGS. **10-11**. Sidewalls **101**, **102**, **103**, **104** are folded into a roughly rectangular configuration and a side wall end flap **124** is adhered or glued to the appropriate side wall **104**. The bottom **105** is folded into the interior space **114** then at least one bottom flap **121** is adhered to another bottom flap **121**. Prior to shipping to a vendor, during the manufacturing process, bottom flaps **121**, FIG. **9** may be fit, stacked, folded together and optionally glued together. A beverage holder end **111** may be attached or adhered in a semi-permanent or permanent manner such as with glue described above to a side wall **101**, **102**, **103**, **104**. A condiment holder end **126** may be attached, glued to a side wall, or left free as shown in FIG. **11** employing a friction lock system. Depending on use, use of glue for attachment or the friction lock system may provide additional stability to the beverage supported food box **100**. The condiment holder end **126** may also be referred to herein as an end portion **126** of the condiment flap **115**. The beverage supported food box **100** of FIGS. **10-11** may then be shipped to vendor, in essentially a flat state that does not take up very much space reducing the cost of shipping and space needed to store the product. FIGS. **12-13** show the method the vendor may use to unfold the box for receiving a food product and end user use. Space in the interior space **114** is created by pulling side walls **101** and **102** apart or away from each other. The top horizontal member **108** of the beverage flap **107** is pulled down. The end of the condiment flap **126** is fit in the slit **122** in the side wall **104** to form the condiment flap **115** to configure the beverage supported food box **100** as shown in FIG. **1**. The condiment cutout **119** is depressed when a condiment container or additional food item container **140** is inserted.

[0140] As shown in FIG. **8**, in use, an end user can slide a beverage container **130** into the beverage aperture(s) **112** and support the beverage with their fingers and hand (not shown). In this way the bottom horizontal member of the beverage flap **109** sit or rests on the user's hand and therefore supports the entire beverage supported food box **100**. The user may then use the other hand to eat a food item contained in the interior space **114** of the beverage supported food box **100**. Further, if desired, a user may dip a food item **150** into a condiment contained in a condiment container **140**. In another use, once the user slides a beverage container **130** into the beverage flap **107**, the user may place the beverage container **130** in a beverage holder, such as in a beverage holder in an arm rest or in a seat in front of the user's seat, wherein the beverage would support the beverage flap **107** and the beverage supported food box **100**, creating a hands-free supported food box.

[0141] In a third embodiment, illustrated in FIGS. **18-25**, a beverage supported food box **300**, may comprise a beverage flap **107** that lacks a vertical member **110**, wherein the top horizontal member **108** and bottom horizontal member **109** are adhered together during manufacturer assembly. As shown in FIG. **25**, an interior end **314** of the top horizontal member **108** and an interior end **315** of the bottom horizontal member **109** may be joined in a seamless fold. During assembly the top horizontal member **108** and bottom horizontal member **109** are folded together and adhered using adhesive, examples of which are described herein. The end of the beverage flap **111** may be adhered to the interior of the side wall **101** but may also be adhered to the exterior of the side wall **101**. The beverage supported food box **300** shown in FIGS. **18-25** may further comprise a condiment flap and or utensil cutout, examples of which are contained herein.

[0142] In a fourth embodiment, illustrated in FIGS. **26-33**, a beverage supported food box **400** a condiment flap **115** wherein the condiment cutout **119** is depressed into the bottom member of the condiment flap **117** and/or the condiment flap vertical wall **118** rather than the side wall **104**. The condiment cutout **119** may be adhered to the condiment flap vertical wall **118** and/or bottom member of the condiment flap **117** to aid in stability of the condiment flap **115**. Further, the

condiment flap **115** may be attached at an end **126** via adhesion or gluing during the manufacturing assembly to a side wall **104**.

[0143] As illustrated in FIG. **33**, the beverage supported food box embodiment **400**, is formed from a single, planar cut paperboard or other example material. During manufacture assembly, sidewalls **101**, **102**, **103**, and **104** may be folded into a roughly rectangular shape and side wall end **124** adhered to side wall **104**. Beverage flap **017** may be folded and adhered with beverage flap end **111** to side wall **101**. Condiment flap **115** may be folded and condiment flap end **126** adhered to side wall **104**. The box may be folded flat for shipping to the vendor as shown in FIGS. **34** and **35**.

[0144] FIGS. **41-51** illustrate an improved food service box of the present disclosure **800**. The improved food service box **800** may comprise a lid **401** that serves as a condiment flap **115**. The dual lid/condiment flap **401/115** comprises at least one but, in this embodiment, at least two condiment cutouts **119**. The lid/condiment flap **401/115** folds into the interior space **114**, covering the interior space and any food item contained therein. The dual lid/condiment flap **401/115** may comprise a top horizontal member **116**, vertical member **118**, and bottom member **117**. The top horizontal member **116** may extend from a side wall **101** and sit substantially horizontally or at about a 90 degree angle from the side wall **101**. The vertical member **118** may extend down at about a 90 degree angle from the top horizontal member **116**. The bottom horizontal member **117** extends down from the vertical member **118** at an angle at or greater than 90 degrees to less than about 175 degrees to extend to the side wall **101**. As shown in FIG. **43**, the free end of the condiment flap **126** (not shown) joined to the bottom member **117** of the dual lid/condiment flap **401/115**, may be attached via a friction lock system wherein the end of the condiment flap **126** slides into a slit **122** in the side wall **101**. The vendor may perform the step of fitting the end of the condiment flap **126** into the sidewall **101**. This enables the improved food service box **800** to be shipped flat from the manufacturer to the vendor as shown in FIGS. **49-50**. As shown in FIGS. **41-51**, the vendor opens the improved food service box **800** essentially to rectangular form, depresses the bottom **105** onto the bottom flaps **121**, and then covers the interior space **114** with the lid/condiment flap **401/115**, inserting condiment flap end **126** into slit **801**, for stacking prior to use or to enclose a food item. This allows the improved food service boxes **800** to be stacked upon each other once assembled by the vendor and/or end user. When a food is enclosed in the food service box, the box may be kept warm under heat lamps or lights. To open the improved service box, a user removes the condiment flap end **126** from the slit **801** in the front, side wall **102** and inserts the end flap **126** into the slit **122** on the adjoining side wall **101**.

[0145] FIGS. **52-61** illustrate a second embodiment of an improved food service box **900**. The improved food service box **900** comprises side flaps **101**, **102**, **103**, **104** that enclose an interior space **114**. The food service box may also be referred to herein as a food container **900**. The food service box **900** may include an integrated condiment flap or holder **115** configured to fit and support a condiment container **140** as shown and described above in FIG. **8**. The food service box **900** may include a first side wall **101** and an opposing second side wall **102**. The first side wall **101** may include a top edge **213**, a bottom edge **106**, and two opposing side edges **214A**, **214B**. Similarly, the second side wall **102** may include a top edge **213**, a bottom edge **106**, and two opposing side edges **214A**, **214B**.

[0146] The food service box **900** may further include a third side wall **103** and an opposing fourth side wall **104**. The third side wall **103** may include a top edge **213**, a bottom edge **106**, and two opposing side edges. The fourth side wall **104** may include a top edge **213**, a bottom edge **106**, and two opposing side edges. The third and fourth side walls **103**, **104** may be connected to the first and second side walls **101**, **102** along their two side edges.

[0147] The food service box **900** may further include a bottom portion comprising bottom flaps **121**. The first, second, third and fourth side walls **101**, **102**, **103**, **104** and the bottom flaps **121** surround an internal container space **114** configured to receive one or more food items **150** as illustrated in FIG. **8**. The bottom portion formed by the bottom flaps **121** may be sized to fit within

a standard vehicle cup holder. The bottom portion may be formed from interlocking extensions of each bottom edge or bottom flaps **121**.

[0148] The food service box **900** may further include a top or condiment flap **115**. The top condiment flap **115** may include an outside edge **126** and a bottom edge **313**. The bottom edge **126** of the top flap **115** may be connected to the side wall top edge **213** of the first side wall **101** along a flap fold line **213/313**.

[0149] The food service box **900** may further include a condiment aperture **901** defined within the top flap **115**. The condiment aperture **901** may be configured to fit and support a condiment container **140** as described above and shown in FIG. **8**. In certain optional embodiments, the condiment aperture **901** may be circular. In other optional embodiments, the condiment aperture **901** may be rectangular or some other shape matching the shape of a condiment container **140**. In some embodiments, the condiment aperture **901** may be an opening. In other embodiments, the condiment aperture **901** may include a removable perforated portion, such as a cut out **119** described and shown above which may help seal the internal container space **114** when the condiment flap **115** is folded over the internal space **114** wherein the food service box **900** is in a closed, stackable configuration.

[0150] The condiment flap **115** of the food service box **900** may be a single flap **116**, or two flaps adhered or connected as in the beverage holder flap **107**, FIGS. **18-25**. In other embodiments the condiment flap **115** includes a first or top member **116**, vertical member **118**, and second or bottom member **117**. The vertical member **118** may lay at about, almost, or roughly, a right angle to the first member **116** and join the first top member **116** with the bottom member **117**. The bottom member **117** may extend from the vertical member **118** at greater than a ninety degree angle to meet and attach to a side wall **101**, **102**, **103**, **104**. An end of the condiment flap **126** connects the condiment flap **115** to a side wall **101**. The connection of the condiment flap end **126** and the side wall **101** may be via a friction lock system as shown wherein a tab end **126** may be notched, or un-notched, and slides into a slit or aperture **122** in the side wall **101**. In other embodiments, the bottom condiment flap **117** may be glued or adhered to the side wall **101** as described above. The condiment flap bottom member **117** may provide additional support for a condiment cup **140** as shown in FIG. **8**.

[0151] In certain optional embodiments, the support portion **116** may include an upper vertical portion **118** and a lower angled portion **117**. The upper vertical portion **118** may provide clearance for the condiment container such that the condiment container does not interfere with the lower angled portion **117** when received by the aperture **901**. The lower angled portion **117** may provide support for the top flap **116**. The upper vertical portion **118** and the lower angled portion **117** may be shaped differently in other embodiments.

[0152] As illustrated in FIGS. **52-53**, The first and second side walls **101**, **102** may be the same height, different heights, or a combination thereof. The third and fourth side walls **103**, **104** may be the same height, different heights, or a combination thereof. Generally, the first side wall **101** may be the tallest side wall so that the top flap **115** may be positioned over the internal container space **114** of the food service box **900** in the closed configuration. In certain optional embodiments, the top edge **213** of the second side wall **102** may have a portion that is the same height as the first side wall **101** and another portion that has a height less than that of the first side wall **101**. Additionally, the third side wall **103** may have a height equal to that of the shorter portion of the second side wall **102** and the fourth side wall **104** may have a height equal to that of the taller portion of the second side wall **102**. In other embodiments, the shapes of the top edges of the side walls, openings, and flaps may be different such as for the condiment flap bottom member **117**, top of side walls **213**, bottom flaps **121**, and condiment aperture **901**. Different height side walls may provide venting to help prevent food received by the internal container space **114** from sweating. The different height side walls may allow better access to food positioned within the internal container space **114** of the food service box **900** when in an open configuration.

[0153] As illustrated in FIG. 61, the food service box 900 may comprise a planar material having a first configuration in which the entire the food service box 900 is flat. As illustrated in FIGS. 52-60, the food service box 900 may comprise a second configuration, partially accomplished at a manufacturing facility and/or at a vending location, in which the food service box 900 is configured for end consumer use with the placement of food within the internal container space 114. Bottom flaps 121 may be adhered, glued fitted, folded, or friction locked together to enclose the interior space 114 and hold a food item. The side wall end flap 124 may be adhered to the fourth side wall 104 to form the food service box 900.

[0154] The dimensions of the food service box 900 may be scaled up or down depending upon the needs of a consumer. Multiple three-dimensional shapes for the food service box 900 are possible including, in non-limiting examples, rectangular, cube, triangular prism, cylindrical, or other shapes as may be afforded by requirements of the design and as shown in other illustrations herein.

[0155] Throughout the specification and claims, the following terms take at least the meanings explicitly associated herein, unless the context dictates otherwise. The meanings identified below do not necessarily limit the terms, but merely provide illustrative examples for the terms. The meaning of “a,” “an,” and “the” may include plural references, and the meaning of “in” may include “in” and “on.” The phrase “in one embodiment,” as used herein does not necessarily refer to the same embodiment, although it may.

[0156] Although the present invention has been described with reference to the disclosed embodiments, numerous modifications and variations can be made and still the result will come within the scope of the invention. No limitation with respect to the specific embodiments disclosed herein is intended or should be inferred. Each apparatus embodiment described herein has numerous equivalents.

Claims

1. A food box configured to engage a beverage container, the food box, when configured for use, comprising: one or more side walls, each of the one or more side walls having a top edge and a bottom edge, the one or more side walls configured to define an internal container space; a beverage flap exterior to the internal container space having a top member and a bottom member, the top member connected to the top edge of a first side wall of the one or more side walls, at least a portion of the bottom member attached to the first side wall; and an aperture defined in the top member and an aperture defined in the bottom member of the beverage flap designed to engage the beverage container.
2. The food box of claim 1, wherein: the one or more side walls include four side walls configured to define the internal container space.
3. (canceled)
4. The food box of claim 1, wherein: the internal container space includes a bottom formed by at least one bottom flap connected to at least one of the one or more side walls.
5. The food box of claim 4, wherein: each of the one or more sides walls includes a bottom flap of the at least one bottom flap.
6. The food box of claim 4, wherein: the bottom of the internal container space is formed by a single bottom flap.
7. The food box of claim 1, wherein: the top member and the bottom member of the beverage flap are parallel.
8. The food box of claim 1, wherein: the top member of the beverage flap contacts the bottom member of the beverage flap.
9. The food box of claim 1, wherein: the beverage flap further includes a side wall portion defined between and configured to separate the top member and the bottom member.
10. The food box of claim 9, wherein: the side wall portion of the beverage flap is positioned distal

to the first side wall.

11. The food box of claim 1, wherein: the beverage flap further includes an end portion extending from the bottom member, the end portion configured to attach the bottom member to the first side wall.

12. The food box of claim 11, wherein: the end portion of the beverage flap is connected to the first side wall via glue.

13. The food box of claim 1, further comprising: an additional flap connected to the top edge of a second side wall of the one or more side walls, the additional flap having a cutout designed to receive a food container.

14. The food box of claim 13, wherein: the cutout is defined in at least a top member of the additional flap, the top member connected to the top edge of the second side wall.

15. The food box of claim 14, wherein: the additional flap further includes a vertical member extending from the top member and a bottom member extending from the vertical member, the bottom member configured to attach to the second side wall.

16. The food box of claim 15, wherein: the top member and the bottom member of the additional flap are parallel.

17. The food box of claim 15, wherein: the additional flap further includes an end portion extending from the bottom member, the end portion configured to attach the bottom member to the second side wall.

18. The food box of claim 17, wherein: the end portion of the additional flap is connected to the second side wall via glue.

19. The food box of claim 17, wherein: the end portion of the additional flap is connected to the second side wall via a friction lock when the end portion is received by a slot defined in the second side wall.

20. A food box comprising: one or more side walls, each of the one or more side walls enclosing an internal container space and having a top edge and a bottom edge; a condiment flap exterior to the internal container space having a top member, a side wall member, and a bottom member, the top member connected to the top edge of a first side wall of the one or more side walls, the bottom member couplable to the first side wall between the top edge and the bottom edge; and at least one cutout defined in the condiment flap and designed to receive a food container, wherein the cutout is formed from a portion of the top member of the condiment flap and is adhered via gluing to the first side wall of the one or more side walls, the side wall member of the condiment flap, and the bottom member of the condiment flap.

21. The food box of claim 20, further comprising: at least one additional cutout defined in the condiment flap and designed to receive a food container, wherein the cutout is formed from a portion of the top member of the condiment flap and is adhered via gluing to the first side wall of the one or more side walls, the side wall member of the condiment flap, and the bottom member of the condiment flap.
